🌍 Geography & World Religions: Reading

World History · Unit 1 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with the Free Hand Map, Religion Packet and Faith & Belief video sheet

Name: _____

Maps and the World's Religions

Historians need maps. A physical map shows natural features such as mountains, rivers and deserts. A political map shows features people created, such as countries, borders and cities. Lines of latitude run east and west and measure distance north or south of the equator. Lines of longitude run north and south and measure distance east or west of the Prime Meridian.

Religion is a set of beliefs and practices about God, gods or the meaning of life. Religions shaped laws, art, holidays and even wars, so we study them before we study world history.

Judaism, Christianity and Islam are monotheistic: they believe in one God. All three trace their roots to Abraham, so they are called Abrahamic religions. Judaism's holy book is the Torah. Christians follow the teachings of Jesus in the Bible. Muslims follow the Quran, which they believe was revealed to the prophet Muhammad, and they practice the Five Pillars.

Hinduism and Buddhism began in India. Hindus worship many gods, which many Hindus see as forms of one spirit called Brahman. Ideas such as karma (actions have results) and reincarnation are central. Buddhism was founded by Siddhartha Gautama, the Buddha, who taught that people can end suffering and reach enlightenment. Sikhism, founded by Guru Nanak in India around 1500, teaches belief in one God and equality of all people.

Check your reading

1. What is the difference between a physical map and a political map?

2. Why are Judaism, Christianity and Islam called Abrahamic religions?

3. Name one idea that Hinduism and Buddhism share.